

WORK IN THE MAKING



PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

age limit of 70 years. (See box *Growth Recipe*) A new organisational structure is emerging at KMB as MD & CEO Dipak Gupta's tenure ends in December; another veteran Gaurang Shah, who was Whole-time Director, retired in October 2022.

But this shift in leadership doesn't bother the new recruits. Under Kotak's watchful eye, there is already a new strategy and team in place to transform KMB into a tech-savvy institution akin to Amazon in terms of customer excellence. And Kotak, 64, will keep a close watch on the proceedings as a member of the board.

GROWTH RECIPE

Nine strategic drivers for the new MD & CEO

- ▶ **TECHNOLOGY AT THE CORE**
- ▶ **LEADERSHIP IN DIGITAL CAPABILITIES**
- ▶ **CUSTOMER CENTRICITY**
- ▶ **LOW-COST DEPOSIT ACCESS EXPANSION**
- ▶ **PURSUE LOANS & ADVANCES GROWTH**
- ▶ **EXECUTE WITH ASSET QUALITY DISCIPLINE AND IMPROVING PRODUCTIVITY**
- ▶ **FINANCIAL INCLUSION AS A BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY**
- ▶ **BUILDING A TEAM OF TALENTED, ENGAGED AND MOTIVATED EMPLOYEES**
- ▶ **PURSUE INORGANIC OPPORTUNITIES**

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TOP TALENT The bank has suggested the names of Shanti Ekambaram (*left*) and K.V.S. Manian to RBI as possible successors to Uday Kotak

THE NEW TEAM'S MANDATE

Let's travel back in time to see how the new strategy unfolded. As the impact of Covid-19 began to wane, Kotak and his senior team recognised the need for new skill sets. The sector had undergone fundamental shifts; with more millennials becoming its customers, there was a need to be more like Amazon: constant availability, seamless transactions, and robust cybersecurity. KMB's plans were set in motion about a year and a half ago. "There are three pillars of the new strategy. The first is to offer an Amazon-like experience. The second fo-